

NEKROSIS

Episode 01: Pilot

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FLASHBACK - 25 YEARS AGO:

1. EXT. BOAT, THE MIDDLE OF THE OCEAN - DAY

THE PROFESSOR (40s M), rigid in his military uniform, stands at the helm of a small BOAT cutting through open water.

Ahead is a solitary SMALL CUBIC STRUCTURE rising directly from the ocean, no island, no shoreline. Inside, an ELEVATOR SHAFT descending straight into the depths of the sea.

KENNETH KELL (V.O.)

(on TV)

For centuries, humanity has defined itself by the hardships it could endure. Hunger, terror, disease... those were the tests that shaped the way we live. But resilience is a primitive metric.

The boat glides in. The Professor ties the rope and steps onto the platform.

CUT TO:

2. INT. THE UNDERWATER SAFEHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

BABY ERYN is crying loud.

KENNETH KELL (V.O.) (CONT'D)

At Djinn International, we chose something radical: *Continuity*.

(beat)

We do not fight to survive, we make survival predictable, reliable... a managed baseline.

BACK TO:

EXT. CUBIC STRUCTURE, THE MIDDLE OF THE OCEAN - CONTINUOUS

KENNETH KELL (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Your biology, synchronized to the rhythms of progress.

The Professor stands before a REINFORCED METAL DOOR embedded in the structure's interior, adjusting a series of mechanical latches in a precise PATTERN to form a sequence.

KENNETH KELL (V.O.) (CONT'D)

With our supplement protocols, we guarantee unlimited access to the means of health.

The final latch clicks. The door SNAPS OPEN.

He lights a CIGAR and steps inside the GLASS-WALLED ELEVATOR that takes him to the UNDERWATER SAFEHOUSE below.

JUMP CUT TO:

INT. THE UNDERWATER SAFEHOUSE - LATER

The safehouse opens into a vast CHAMBER. The curved glass walls reveal the ocean beyond, dark waters, fish, sea turtles and drifting particles. Heavy drapes hang between glass partitions, and the furniture feels feudal in posture, engineered in function.

A TV plays... On screen, KENNETH KELL (40s), CEO of DJINN INTERNATIONAL, stands on stage beneath Djinn's Logo. He addresses an audience.

KENNETH KELL (CONT'D)

(on TV)

Welcome to the new age. Welcome to
Djinn International.

GENERAL JULIANA JEZWELL (40s F), a massive, muscular woman in civilian clothes, sits in a leather sofa, cradling BABY ERYN.

The PROFESSOR stands facing the glass wall, tapping his foot against the floor nervously.

He shuts off the TV. His face is a storm of fury and fear.

PROFESSOR

How can this be? I saw him die...

JULIANA JEZWELL

Then your eyes deceived you,
Professor.

PROFESSOR

(paranoid)

It's impossible.

Juliana COUGHS. The Professor looks at her, worried.

PROFESSOR (CONT'D)

General, you know what this means,
don't you? The real threat is still
out there. After everything we've
done? All the people we've killed?
It's not fair --

JULIANA JEZWELL

There was nothing "fair" about
Nekrosis. As long as you and I are
alive, the threat will always be.
The mission is over.

PROFESSOR
(stubborn)
Not for me.

Juliana's gaze softens as she looks at Baby Eryn.

JULIANA JEZWELL
There are more important things.

PROFESSOR
What's his name?

JULIANA JEZWELL
Eryn.

PROFESSOR
Eryn? Don't you think I ever wanted
an "Eryn" of my own, General? But,
I assure you, I'm not bringing one
to this world knowing *Nekrosis* can
be back. Think of what could happen
to Eryn, to all of us, if *Nekrosis*
is back. War is coming. You have to
help me!

JULIANA JEZWELL
"War is coming"...
(chuckles)
Professor, do you ever listen to
yourself talking?

PROFESSOR
But --

JULIANA JEZWELL
(snaps)
ENOUGH! This is the last time I
wanna hear about this!

JULIANA COLLAPSES, catching herself just in time to keep the
baby from falling.

Baby Eryn SCREAMS.

The Professor rushes forward to help her.

PROFESSOR
Juliana!

Juliana forces herself upright, hiding her pain. She clutches
Eryn protectively, rocking him to calm his cries.

The Professor watches them closely, suspicion creeping across
his face.

END FLASHBACK.

3. EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Rain slicks the crowded, neon-lit street. CAR HORNS blare. People SHOUT and CURSE from windows.

ERYN JEZWELL (26 M), slim, pale, wearing a soaked delivery jacket with his NAME TAG on it, crouches by an aging MOTORCYCLE. A BIOMETRIC COOLER hums on the back, its display showing: "PHARMACEUTICAL PRIORITY - STABLE".

He checks the expiration codes on a row of vials, all labeled with Djinn's Logo.

ERYN'S POV: A cluster of friends laugh and stumble out of a bar, clinking bottles of Djinn Soda. Behind them, a towering KENNETH KELL BILLBOARD glows through the rain.

His eyes stay fixed on the billboard, exhausted. His jaw clenches.

A CUSTOMER (20s F) approaches clutching a prescription slate, shivering under her umbrella.

CUSTOMER

Hey, buddy... Please tell me this
is for me!

Eryn doesn't react, still locked on the billboard.

CUSTOMER (CONT'D)

Hello? Are you even listening?

She taps on his shoulder. Eryn snaps back to reality and FLINCHES after she touches him.

ERYN

(startled)

Oh! Sorry. I wasn't with you. ID
and subscription.

She shows him her ID and her Djinn subscription. Eryn nods. He fumbles the cooler open while she prepares her money...

ERYN

Maintenance tabs?

CUSTOMER

No, just metabolic supplements. Uh,
it's in the paper.

ERYN

Okay.

One vial rolls toward the curb.

The customer bends to grab it. She hesitates. Their hands touch.

He almost lets her help, then pulls back sharply, snatching it first.

ERYN
(hollow)
I got it. Here you go.

He hands it over. She GRABS his hand.

CUSTOMER
(gets closer, voice low)
Listen to me...

Eryn freezes.

CUSTOMER (CONT'D)
You got anything... off-menu? Maybe
some of those unmarked platinum
tabs.

ERYN
(cuts her off, insulted)
"Unmarked"?

CUSTOMER
I can pay!

He stares at her for a long beat.

CUSTOMER (CONT'D)
I didn't mean to --
(shows money, pathetic)
Just give me the box and say you
were robbed!
(beat)
Please?

ERYN
(emotionless, dismissive)
Fuck off.

She takes it and hurries off into the rain. Eryn watches her go, faintly stung but his eyes are dead.

4. EXT. DINER - NIGHT

A small roadside diner, half-swallowed by the woods.

A large VAN is parked outside.

INT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

A TV hangs above the counter, cycling through local news.
FOOTAGE: Crowded distribution depots, citizens arguing over
drug supplements.

REPORTER (V.O.)

Continued shortages in Djinn's new baseline maintenance tabs for the past few weeks sparks wide outrage among the company's subscribers...

Inside, BLACKOUT (28 M) sits alone at a corner booth. Lean, fit, fingers tapping against the table.

His eyes flick from his plate to the VAN'S DRIVER eating across the room. He notices a GUN in the driver's belt.

REPORTER (V.O.) (CONT'D)

The Vice Prime Minister said that the crisis will be and I quote: "temporary and manageable". Djinn International, however, issued no statement...

AYA (27 F) slides into the booth beside him with an opened GLASS SODA in hand, not a Djinn brand.

AYA

(hands him the soda)

Here.

Blackout instantly notices a faint stain on the rim and breadcrumbs floating near the surface.

BLACKOUT

(stammering)

L -- Look. I can't. I can't drink this.

AYA

What? Why?

BLACKOUT

It's dirty. There's like... bread in it and stuff. And I told you I don't like this.

AYA

It was this or that Djinn diarrhea they serve in a bottle.

BLACKOUT

Go -- Go return it then.

AYA

No. I already paid.

BLACKOUT

He'll give you back your money.

AYA

Well, this place isn't exactly five stars, is it? It's open. He won't.

She sets the soda aside.

BLACKOUT

You l -- leave it there?

AYA

You don't wanna drink it. Neither do I. So... eyes on the driver.

BLACKOUT

Got him.

Aya turns away, scrolling political threads on a Reddit-like online forum called *Angst*...

Blackout's eyes shift again toward the van driver, now finishing his meal.

BLACKOUT

(suddenly)

You just gonna let him scam you like that?

AYA

What is wrong with you?? You didn't even pay for it, dude. Just drop it already.

The driver tosses a tip and heads for the door.

Blackout rises.

BLACKOUT

(low, urgent)

Ch -- Ch -- Check the van, Aya.

AYA

(snaps)

Wait.

Aya slides her phone into her coat and follows him out.

EXT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

The driver approaches the van. Blackout moves in, stabbing him once with his katar weapon. The driver falls into the mud.

The van's rear doors slam open. TWO DJINN SECURITY AGENTS burst out, rifles raised.

Aya draws her GUN and drops behind a car. She fires twice, one agent falls. Another attempts to flank.

Blackout shoots him through the open diner doorway.

Seconds of silence follow. Aya checks the bodies without expression.

BLACKOUT
(hoarse)
Cargo?

Aya pries the latch: Rows of crates filled with SUPPLEMENTS and BASELINE MAINTENANCE TABS, Djinn Logo stamped across each one. She throws Blackout a look. No words.

JUMP CUT TO:

They pour gasoline over the boxes and throw a lighter inside before taking a few steps back.

The van BURNS and EXPLODES.

Without a word, Blackout and Aya vanish into the dark woods.

5. INT. PHARMACY - NIGHT

Eryn steps in, dripping wet, helmet tucked under his arm.

On the wall is the same KENNETH KELL ad. Beside it, a bright poster of a smiling mother and child holding DJINN SLEEPING PILLS. Djinn Logo everywhere.

The place is crowded with CIVILIANS huddled in line. Most look pale, tired, half-frozen...

CLERK
(doesn't look up)
Next. What can I get you?

Eryn steps forward. The clerk glances up and recognizes him.

CLERK (CONT'D)
You? Don't you work here?

ERYN
No, I'm independent. I deliver medical supplies.

CLERK
Right... ID?

ERYN
Actually this is for personal use. Somnibryl pills.

CLERK
Delisted.

ERYN
(starts to panic)
Delisted? Any alternatives?

CLERK
Yeah. Djinn Neurotabs. More effective even... Last shipment is reserved for platinum subscribers. But, since you practically work for us, I can get you some.

ERYN
No, no. No need to do that.

CLERK
It's okay. But you should know, it got pricier since last month.

Eryn hesitates. Behind him, the line stirs with frustration.

CUSTOMER
(to Eryn, annoyed, rude)
Take your shit and move already!

ERYN
(bothered but ignores him)
How pricey?

CLERK
Fifty silver pieces. You should've registered sooner.

ERYN
Never mind.
(beat)
I'll be back next week.

He turns sharply and exits, slamming the door behind him.

6. INT. ERYN'S HOME - NIGHT

He pulls up to a modest, weathered cabin. Not rich, not poor.

The front door is wide open. Eryn freezes, then steps inside cautiously. From deeper in the house... A LOUD COUGH. It's JULIANA JEZWELL (now in her 60s), his old, sick mother.

Eryn drops his helmet and sprints down the hall.

7. INT. JULIANA'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

JULIANA is on her knees, trembling, frantically dragging a PILE OF MEDICAL BILLS and DOCUMENTS toward a lighter. She flicks it.

ERYN

Mom?! Mom, what is this?

He lunges and grabs her wrists.

JULIANA JEZWELL

(disoriented)

Eryn? What the fuck are you doing here?

ERYN

Okay. That's enough, Mom. You're starting to freak me out.

JULIANA JEZWELL

Who... opened the gates to hell again?

She jerks, trying to flick the lighter.

JULIANA JEZWELL (CONT'D)

So that *pestilence* can walk again among the living...

ERYN

Mom, stop. They're just some medical bills.

He grabs the medical bills she's trying to burn and notices Djinn International Logo on some of them.

JULIANA JEZWELL

Nekrosis.

ERYN

(confused)

What?

JULIANA JEZWELL

They're here, Eryn...

(coughs hard)

Nekrosis.

ERYN

What? *Nekrosis*? Mom, what are you saying--?

She SLAPS him.

JULIANA JEZWELL

Yeah... You keep your fucking distance, boy.

He takes a second to calm down.

ERYN
(gentle, desperate)
Mom... It's just your disease
messing with you. Again. I'm going
back to the pharmacy. I'll figure
it out. I always do.

JULIANA JEZWELL
GET DOWN!!

She shoves him hard. He CRASHES to the floor.

Juliana collapses.

Eryn, starting to panic, scrambles up and catches her before
she hits the ground.

ERYN
Don't worry. I'll -- I'll take you
to the hospital. Just calm down,
okay?

Juliana clutches his hoodie, trying to say something.

JULIANA JEZWELL
No, Eryn. No. Don't -- Don't --

She blacks out.

8. EXT. HOSPITAL ER - NIGHT

A TAXI screeches through the hospital gates and parks in
front of the ER entrance.

A GATEKEEPER hurries over, waving his arms.

GATEKEEPER
You can't park here.
Turn back.

The rear door bursts open.

ERYN stumbles out, cradling the unconscious JULIANA in his
arms.

ERYN
Out of the way, it's an emergency!

TAXI DRIVER
HEY! You didn't pay me!

ERYN
(running to the entrance)
I'll be right back!

Eryn looks back at the driver knowing he won't be back.